

THE CROSSROADS

Special Cover Page Celebrating the 'Swachh CIRS Seva' Initiative by our Grade 12 CBSE Students in the popular 'Studio Ghibli' style.



04

SADHANA – HOW IT IMPACTED ME

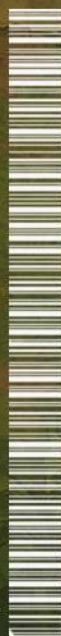
M. K. Prateethi – CHYK, CIRS

FAILING LIKE A CHAMPION

Aryaman Bansal

HARNESSING YOUTH POTENTIAL THROUGH DYNAMIC SPIRITUALITY
THEME OF THE YEAR 2025

April 2025 | Issue 23



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#CIRSCaptures - Saharsh Bansal (XII)
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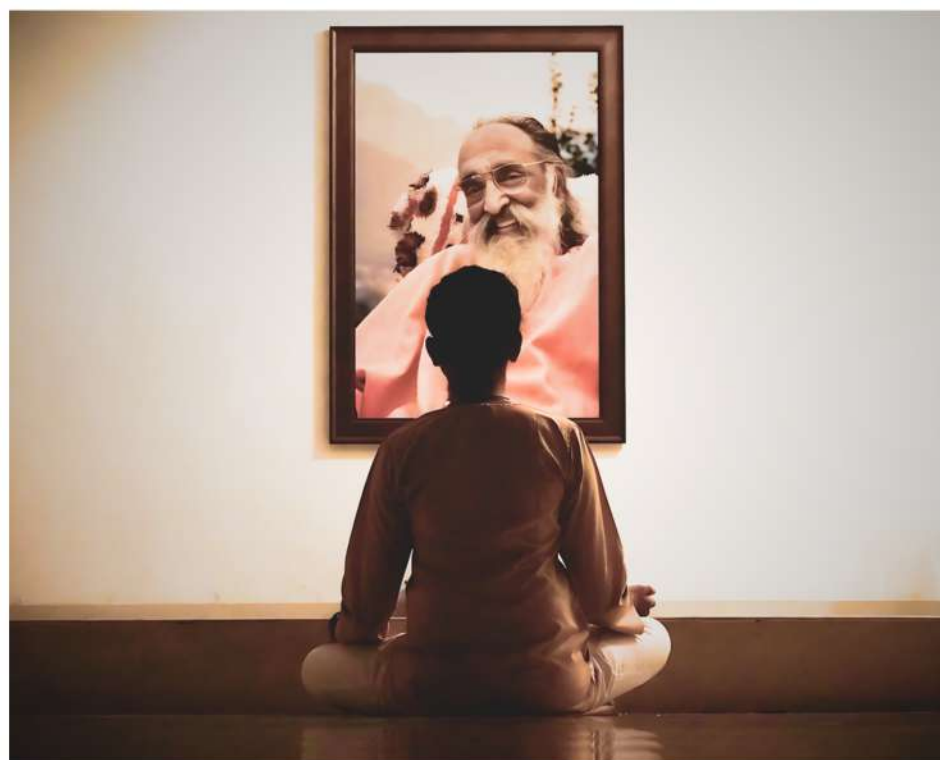
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'Harnessing Youth Potential Through Dynamic Spirituality'

Any organization has to have direction and focus to its objectives if it is to function properly. Thus, to guide the activities and programs of the Chinmaya Yuva Kendra, the youth wing of the Chinmaya Mission, Pujya Gurudev Swami Chinmayananda ji framed its motto as:



- Swami Anukoolananda

'Motto' is defined by the Oxford dictionary as:

'A SHORT SENTENCE OR PHRASE THAT IS USED AS A GUIDE OR RULE OF BEHAVIOR OR AN EXPRESSION OF THE AIMS OR IDEALS OR OBJECTIVE OF AN INSTITUTION, A COUNTRY, A FAMILY, ETC.'

And it is to commemorate the Golden Jubilee year of the Chinmaya Yuva Kendra that CIRS has adopted the CHYK motto as the theme for this year. Here, we shall be delving into the hidden import behind these simple words that are a powerful and inspiring clarion call to the youth of today to rise, act and achieve.

YOU HARNESSING YOUTH POTENTIAL: YOUTH

Look around. You will see dynamism bursting through every pore of every being - the sun, the wind, the oceans, skies and even the earth brim with potential, with energy, with strength and with vigor and vitality. So too, the youth brim with potential. Youthful energy is dynamic, full of potential to act. It is ever-restless, seeking innumerable channels to explore, experiment and express.

This energy, when misguided and unrestrained, runs wild and wreaks havoc in society, bringing great loss and pain. The potential of many present-day youth is indeed wasted away in numerous self-defeating endeavors.

“

HOWEVER, THE SAME ENERGY WHEN HARNESSSED WITH A DISCIPLINED MIND AND NOBLE INTELLECT GETS CONCENTRATED INTO PROFITABLE CHANNELS, IT BECOMES CAPABLE OF TREMENDOUS PRODUCTIVE EFFORT, MANIFESTING UNFATHOMABLE BLESSINGS UPON MANKIND. ”

The Upanishads define a youth by three qualities – आशिष्ठ – optimism; दृढिष्ठ – determination; and बलिष्ठ – strength. The Upanishads further declare, “To such a youth, the whole world lays out all its treasures.”

Hence, the youth have to be of sound mind, positive and aspirational, viewing the world with eyes of love, empathy, compassion and kindness. They must have a profound and powerful intellect, holding lofty visions and noble ideals, with the knowledge, skills, and the necessary enthusiasm and determination to achieve those ideals. They should have a strong body, disciplined senses and dexterous hands to work out their plans to fruition.

First, we need to discover this potential in ourselves. Then it has to be tapped effectively in ways that help the unfoldment of our personality and service of humanity.



YOU THROUGH DYNAMIC SPIRITUALITY: YOUTH

“TRAINING OF THE MIND IS THE ESSENCE OF EDUCATION”,

SAID PUJYA GURUDEV SWAMI CHINMAYANANDA JI.

And dynamic spirituality is the best means we can employ to tap and harness this hidden potential within youngsters. Spirituality in its actual meaning aims at personality unfoldment leading to the discovery of one’s true nature, presently hidden in oneself. The culmination of the spiritual journey is in the experience of oneness in all creation. There is no differentiation based on caste, creed, color, religion, or any other external factor. Due to this sense of oneness with all, a realized individual experiences a natural outpouring of love towards all beings. Any action undertaken from then on would be of service to the entire world.

The outer expression of spirituality is lovable service of the entirety of creation. The inner foundation for service is love that is based on the vision of spirituality. This can happen only when all activities that we undertake are divinized by the touch of spirituality. Thus, dynamic spirituality means the service of all creation with total love for all.

Harnessing is the process of effectively channelizing seemingly distinct things or abilities toward the attainment of one goal. Spiritual knowledge, its techniques and its practices develop the mind’s capacity of focused application. Conviction in noble values - born of sincere study, reflection and ardent practice - births transformation in a person. Such an individual will manifest a powerful and noble character and personality for himself. Deployed in spiritual dynamism, he will undertake massive programs and projects in selfless service for the entire world.

Abi
Love
Positivity
Goals
Potential
Happy
Health
Motivation
Training
aspire

Such is the glorious vision of Pujya Gurudev which has been codified as the Chinmaya Vision Program. It is this expansive vision for transformation that forms the foundation of the system of education in all our Chinmaya institutions.

Many die without realizing why they were born. Some die regretting that they did not achieve what they were born for. A rare few march into death with total fulfillment of a life gloriously lived. May ours be such a glorious life, very well lived, in the manifestation of our highest potential, in total inner unfoldment and immeasurable service of mankind.

Hari Om!

**“A RARE FEW
MARCH INTO DEATH
WITH TOTAL
FULFILLMENT
OF A LIFE
GLORIOUSLY LIVED.
MAY OURS
BE SUCH A LIFE.”**



Through Their Lens

IN CONVERSATION WITH GRADE VII AND GRADE XII

If you could relive one CIRS event, what would it be?

Grade 12

Saturday afternoon English classes! From Grade 5 to 12, the sheer fun we have had during this time is unimaginable.

- Raghav Agarwala | 12 SCI

Anand Utsav '24. The experience, the people, the energy; I don't think I'll find it anywhere else in the world.

- Anant Varma | 12 SCI

Sports time. Whenever we came together and played, my inner self showed its true colors!

- Geeth Koushal | 12 MGMT

Janmashtami's midnight program. The amazing ambience, bhajans, play and birth of Shri Krishna are just unmissable.

- Tavishi | 12 MGMT

The special people who are there for me at any time and teach me so many things - teachers! They all always put a smile on my face!

- Kartik Jain

Being with my friends Magendra, Pirai, Nidharshan, Shubham, Shreeju, Janak, Aarush, Vyom and Deveshwar!

- Adhav Sivan

The opportunities that we get to explore in fields like sports, academics and extracurriculars. It helps me find out what I am the best at.

- Yuvika Agarwal

Sunday calling as I get to talk to my parents and unwind after a week of hard work.

- S. Aradhya

Grade 7

Which aspect of CIRS brings you maximum happiness?

HOW TO: PUBLIC SPEAKING

AADITYA TULSYAN | GRADE X, CIRS

A microphone is the greatest tool to lead, create impact, share ideas and simply blow away an audience's mind. And public speaking is the art of using that very microphone to its maximum. It is essential to grow in society, and is a skill you find in all successful people.

Despite the plethora of benefits, many people face challenges before they can pick up a microphone. But don't worry, that's exactly what this article is for: to show you ways to face those challenges and tell you HOW TO: PUBLIC SPEAKING.

Let's start with some easy tips. At the outset, ensure you know your audience. Also know the number of people you are speaking to so you don't feel overwhelmed when you're on stage. Practice, practice and keep practicing your speech to remove even the slightest stammer that can ruin your talk.

Craft a well-structured speech including stories, personal anecdotes and some great jokes. Before starting, calm your nerves, take deep breaths and relax your mind. During your speech, use hand gestures, confident body language and constant eye contact with your audience. Make sure your talk is entertaining and engages the audience at all times.

Enhance your tone, pitch and modulation to express yourself clearly. End with a strong finish that will leave a lasting impact. "People will forget what you said but they will never forget how you made them feel", says Maya Angelou. Take small pauses so the audience can interpret and think over what you say. As Sir Ralph Richardson says, "The most precious things in speeches are the pauses." Use the silence to catch your breath and give the audience time to absorb what you're saying. Even if you forget a part of your speech, remember that only YOU know that; your audience doesn't.

At times, fear of judgement and failure can pull people away from grabbing the microphone and unlocking their full potential. The only solution is to face that fear head on. The more often you do, the more the fear will fade away. So use the tips and strategies provided above to improve your public speaking skills and empower yourself to become a better communicator and leader. The stage is all yours!



AMBIGUITY: Navigating the Shadows

TAVISH TIBREWAL | XII MGMT, CIRS



Ambiguity is not just something that makes us dance between multiple possibilities, but is a patent force that drives our actions, shapes our perceptions and defines our understanding of the world. It can range from the minute discrepancies that we see within our friends to the grand interpretations that shape the narratives of society.

We know that ambiguity can have both negative and positive impacts on the human mind. Let us first see the dark side of ambiguity. Ambiguity can cause a lot of misunderstandings, which can be costly in communication-intensive vocations like law, medicine, diplomacy, etc. Here, it can cause cognitive dissonance as we are not clear about our thoughts, which might affect our personal and professional relationships with people. Ambiguity can also reduce efficiency as it consumes valuable resources in analyzing different possibilities and useless actions. If someone is not clear about the instructions given, he will not perform the task correctly and will need additional clarification which will waste time.

However, ambiguity is not just a mere source of problems but also has a lot of positive impacts which help us grow in society and express our talents.

Ambiguity ignites engagement in literature and art by inviting diverse interpretations. Ambiguity also encourages innovation and creativity as it helps us to think in different directions and shape our perceptions on different viewpoints and ideas. This can lead to technological breakthroughs, scientific advancements and economic development in the country. In the volatile field of business, ambiguity helps us to keep our options open by giving us the power to revise plans on short notice considering various impacts of a decision.

The way individuals perceive and respond to ambiguous situations helps us understand whether the impact was beneficial or detrimental. The ability to juggle multiple possibilities in our mind is closely tied to 'ambiguity tolerance', a term that refers to the degree to which an individual can comfortably face ambiguity. People with high ambiguity tolerance are prone to foster more creativity and take it as an opportunity to think and innovate. However, people with low ambiguity tolerance may find it difficult to explore new dimensions and may face frustration, anger and sometimes fear. The factor which mainly influences ambiguity tolerance is the number of past experiences that involve exposure to unpredictable situations.



Fortunately, ambiguity tolerance is not a fixed trait. Rather, it can be developed by following certain practices. Practices like meditation help us become aware of our thoughts and can help in analyzing our past decisions and learning from our mistakes. Another way to enhance ambiguity tolerance is by changing our mindset. We usually tend to have a fixed mindset and end up limiting our thoughts; instead, we must take each situation as an opportunity so we can learn and grow unconditionally. When things are unclear, we must ask pertinent questions that give us the confidence to explore new dimensions and make informed decisions.

In conclusion, the dance between shadow and light within ambiguity is an indication of the complexity that humans experience. In the above paragraphs, we have seen how ambiguity can both hinder or propel our growth, creating downfalls or pathways to innovation. Thus, we must not eliminate ambiguity but cultivate its positive version until we see each situation as a new opportunity. By fostering high ambiguity tolerance and seeing what best we can do everywhere, we can successfully channel ambiguity's potential to shape an innovative and creative world.

THE SILENT STORM



RAJESHWARI KEJRIWAL | IB II YEAR, CIRS

She's timid and shy,
Her voice soft, barely loud.
But one day, she swears, she'll roar
And make us all proud.

When the world is watching,
She'll dazzle the crowd.
She may fall and stumble—
They'll say, "Don't let her out."
But she'll keep marching forward,
Silencing every doubt.

Every "what if" and "if not"—
She'll crush them all out.
She's laughter and grace -
Gentle yet unbreakable.
Her light never falters,
Her empathy, unmistakable.
Even in the darkest times,
Her spirit is unshakable.
So don't dare call her hush.
Within her quiet might,
A blazing fire resides -
Enough to light a candle,
Or set the world alight.

इश्वरीहान्ड

How it Impacted Me

When I took up my sadhana, I didn't believe it would bring much change in me. I saw it only as a challenge to improve my consistency. I started with something very small - chanting the Gayatri Mantra 11 times everyday. Surprisingly, this proved to be a VERY BIG challenge as it rigorously tested my concentration, flow of thoughts and self-awareness.

A couple of weeks or so after starting, I began to see that I had a little bit of control over the flow of my thoughts. Then I increased the chanting to 21 times and faced the same obstacles. But due to the mental control I had gained from my previous practice, I managed to overcome them much more easily this time around.

At this point, I noticed a change in myself that went deeper than just my qualities or mental state. I found that the regular sadhana had impacted my very character: I was now much more mindful of my actions and this was only increasing. Sadhana for me had evolved into a form of self-discipline that ensured that no matter where I was, what I was doing, my mind would tell me at exactly 7 PM, "YOU HAVE TO DO GAYATRI MANTRA!" I see now that the only difficult part is to start and maintain your consistency; once you have gotten over the primary hurdles you are more than halfway to transforming yourself for the better.



M. K. PRATEETI | XII SCI, CIRS

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In essence, sadhana is a powerful tool that builds self-discipline in a person. This helps people work towards their goals and successfully achieve them. But how we utilize this tool is totally up to us. And thus came the next BIG challenge for me: To focus on the higher goals I want to achieve, I must do more sadhana and put in more hard work to achieve it.

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FAILING LIKE A CHAMPION

ARYAMAN BANSAL | GRADE X, CIRS

"IF YOU FALL SEVEN TIMES, GET BACK UP EIGHT TIMES."

-JAPANESE PROVERB

Considered the greatest basketball player of all time, Michael Jordan played for the Chicago Bulls and the Washington Wizards for fifteen seasons. He broke over 200 records, many of which are still unbeaten decades after his retirement. During his career, he played in 563 games in which he scored more than 30 points. In the 1990s, newspapers reported Jordan's records practically every week, but almost never mentioned the mistakes he had made.

Michael Jordan is known for having been one of the most disciplined players when it came to training. He was literally tireless. He would get up at 5 in the morning to start shooting baskets, even if it was the weekend or his day off. And extremely interestingly, he is also well known for failing to make so many game-winning shots. Wait a second! What was that? Michael Jordan famous for missing - and not making - a shot?! Allow me to explain.

After retiring, when reporters asked Jordan how he had managed to be a champion, he surprised everyone by saying: "I've missed more than 9,000 shots in my career. I've lost almost 300 games. Twenty-six times, I've been trusted to take the game-winning shot, and I missed it. I've failed over and over and over again in my life. And that is why I succeed."

When you see social media, news, or television, you see celebrities that usually give you the feeling that they are people who have instant success. The problem is that you don't get to see the work and discipline that led to their success. Whenever you see someone succeed, think about all the hard work and effort they have put in. Then ask yourself: WHAT DOES THAT PERSON DO THAT I DON'T?

Mostly, you'll find that they incorporated habits into their lives, and made sacrifices that got them to where they are. You might not need to get up at as early as five in the morning like Roger Federer did even after retirement, but you can learn such things from biographies of successful people that will help you succeed. And learning to fail is one of them. If you want to be a champion, you have to train without being afraid of making mistakes. In fact, the more times you get something wrong, the more you will learn.



The primary reason some people stand out from the crowd is that they have practiced their skills more than others have. People often feel disappointed when things don't work out as they'd like. What differentiates a champion from the rest is that the champion is capable of leaving their disappointment behind and trying again. Their secret is to keep practicing. In fact, learning from your failure is the best fuel you can use to up your game. Each time you get something wrong, make your game stronger so you don't make the same mistake in the future. Remember that each mistake you correct brings you one step closer to the goal you want to achieve.

“FAILURE IS
SIMPLY THE
OPPORTUNITY
TO BEGIN AGAIN,
THIS TIME
MORE
INTELLIGENTLY.

Henry Ford”

When you are learning something, especially in the beginning, getting rid of the fear of making mistakes will help you progress. Here are some suggestions for overcoming this crippling fear:

- If you are learning a new language, practice it with native speakers whenever possible, without feeling embarrassed.
- If you are studying for exams, do practice exercises to identify your mistakes and correct them before the actual test.
- If you have joined a sports team, practice more than anyone else before games and official competitions.



Chances are that you have already made a lot of mistakes in your life until now. Who hasn't? So make a list of your 'Greatest Failures', adding what you learned from each one of them. You're probably used to seeing 'Greatest Hits' lists in music and other fields so it might seem strange to put together a mistakes chart, but you will find it very useful to accelerate your growth. As the economist, speaker, and writer Alex Rovira says, many people do not recover from sudden success, but everyone learns something from failure. What have you learned from YOUR failures?

In a video game, a character becomes stronger as they survive. In the same way, you too are like a game character, gaining expertise as you go along. You start at level one and the more you win or lose, the more knowledge you will gain to level up in the game of life. The difference between video games and real life is that in games one can restart any battle if one loses. But in real life, we have no choice but to live with our choices. Hence, carefully choose the battles you want to get involved in and don't be afraid of things going wrong. Each time you fall, ensure to get back up with greater experience and wisdom.

Now I will conclude with this quote: "It ain't about how hard you hit, it's about how hard you can get hit and keep moving forward. How much you can take and keep moving forward. That's how winning is done!"

READING

SHAGUN PARMANANDKA | GRADE X, CIRS

A few years ago, not very far from here, there lived a girl. She enjoyed her childhood just like any other kid but there was one problem in her carefree life. Though her days were spent in laughter, in the silence of the dark nights one could hear the cries of her mind. As the world around would sleep, she was forced to follow a gruesome routine: Her mother would force her to read line after line from huge books with big, fat pages bundled together. The girl did not like it, the words would float off the book, and her eyes would start drooping the very minute she began.

Now the same girl lives right here in CIRS and she cannot escape her desire to read. She loves books now, it's like they give her life and new lessons. Now she can open a book and step into an enchanting world, a place where she feels free. . .

Such was my transformation: From someone who couldn't stand books to one who can never give up the habit. But such transformations take a lot of time and sometimes it's also the time and effort of the people around us. For me, it was my mother who sparked that change in me. All of us have that special person, or group of people, that have inspired us to do something greater in life.

My mother showed me that reading was better than watching cartoons on TV. It is due to her that I developed an interest in books. And as I continued reading I could see benefits such as vocabulary building, enhanced concentration and development in my thought process seep into me.



In fact, books can help with our academic studies as well. For example, if you didn't understand a particular concept, you could read beyond the curriculum to strengthen your knowledge about the topic and clarify any doubts.

As I grew older, my mother also taught me about another very valuable benefit of reading - its positive impact on the spoken language of a person. Communication plays an important role in our lives, and we must build on our speaking skills. I learnt that reading any kind of book, from any genre and writing style, improves our communication skills. The books and words we read form various new series of thoughts in our mind. Since these thoughts are generated over a period of time, they tend to stay for longer. The more we feed our mind with such thoughts, the more our flow of speech improves. To help you understand this better, take the example of a creeper. Creepers need something to hold onto to grow. Once fully grown, it can pull itself up higher and higher with no aid. In the same way, we too can use books as a pillar to strengthen our speech.

To conclude, books have way more to offer than what meets the eye. If you don't usually read, why not give it a try to experience the wonders for yourself? Why not find your inspiration to pick up that book you've been putting off for a long time? After all, it only takes a few seconds to make the decision that will start you off on a lifetime of amazing exploration and discovery.

Sanctuary of Self-Discovery - A Vanguard Story



To me, Vanguard is more than just a club. In fact, I don't think it should be labelled as anything even remotely close to it. It is a call to action that gives me a push in the right direction when I stray off the path of righteousness. It is that voice in the back of my head that reminds me of my values in all situations. It is that driving force that pushes me to constantly work hard to be better than I am today. It is these morals, lessons, values and actions of pure love that made me adhere to my values when all around me people were breaking theirs.

I am not saying that Vanguard has made me into some sort of perfect person who has never faltered before and never will. I am saying that it has forced me to be more conscious of all that is higher in me. It is what makes me reach for perfection instead of falling for the lower. And the most important thing is that when I fall, I know how to get up again.

For at the end of the day, it is not my friends or my seniors who I can go to when I falter in my values or am unable to handle a situation, it is Vanguard that I confide in. Vanguard is thus a place where I know I will get a solution with zero judgement attached, a place where I will be taught and made to understand with love.

To put it simply, I have learnt more from Vanguard mentorship sessions in the past few months, than I have after 15 years of life. If I had to state one reason why Gurudev may have directed me to this school I would say it is to learn in and from Vanguard.

**Sharanya Kolipaka | Grade X |
Vanguard Class of 2024**

“

I have learnt more from Vanguard mentorship sessions in the past few months, than I have after 15 years of life.

”

I came into this school not knowing the 'V' of virtue, more spoiled than any other brat in my batch and fully ignorant of myself and my potential. My life was set to be mediocre, average, and just a statistic. But then, something happened: I decided to give the interview for this leadership programme called Vanguard, and what was even more surprising was that I got accepted. I was accepted into a room that delivered a quality of leadership training that only international organisations could deliver. Thus began my journey from an average student to a Vanguard candidate to, now, a potential mentor. Vanguard is an organization built upon its mentors - that is why it is so strong and rigid. They were the ones who helped me realise my potential in quizzing, and they inspired me to develop myself not just to become average at my potential, but to become the best in the world. In conclusion, I do not have a lot to say about this organisation except for this: I owe the person I am today to them.

**Viraj Lal | Grade X |
Vanguard Class of 2024**



BRAVE HEARTS

OF BHARAT

Khudiram Bose:

He went to the noose smiling, choosing death over slavery under British rule! Born on 3 December, 1889 in the small village of Habibpur, West Bengal, the fearless Khudiram Bose joined hands with revolutionary groups that attacked the British not just with words, but guns as well! He learnt how to make bombs, and even volunteered to plant them himself. It was when Khudiram Bose and Prafulla Chaki targeted Douglas H Kingsford - infamous for his brutal torture of jailed revolutionaries - that the former was caught. When asked by the judge what his last wish was, Khudiram replied, "To teach all Indians how to make bombs!" This revolutionary went to the gallows smiling and holding his Gita on 11 August, 1908, aged just 18 years old, but brave beyond his years.



Banda Singh Bahadur:

Baba Banda Singh Bahadur was appointed as the general of the Sikh army in 1708. As town after town fell to his daring raids, the Mughal ruler Bahadur Shah sent his entire army to crush him once and for all. After 7 years of daring escapes, Banda Singh and his men were trapped in the fort of Gurdas Nangal. For 8 long months, the Sikhs resisted the siege by 100,000 Mughal troops under the harshest conditions. Finally, the desperate Mughal commander proposed a fake offer for peace and took the fort by treachery. Choosing death over conversion to Islam, Banda Singh was brutally tortured and executed on the 9th of June, 1776. Despite this, the flame of resistance that he ignited inspired countless other Sikhs to join the revolution and fight the tyrannical Mughals.



2LT Arun Khetarpal:

During the Indo-Pakistan War of 1971, Second Lieutenant Arun Khetarpal's tank regiment was ordered to attack a troop of Pakistani tanks during the bloody Battle of Basantar. When his tank was hit by enemy fire and started burning, his commanding officer asked him to evacuate. But the 21 year old Khetarpal said "No, Sir, I will not abandon my tank. My main gun is still working and I will get them!" Then, another shell hit his tank, killing this brave son of Bharat. For his unimaginable bravery, second lieutenant Arun Khetarpal was posthumously awarded the Param Vir Chakra. The citation read: "Second Lieutenant Arun Khetarpal was dead but he had, by his intrepid valor saved the day; the enemy was denied the breakthrough he was so desperately seeking. Not one enemy tank got through."





Lachit Borphukan:

A legendary military commander of the Ahom Dynasty, Lachit Borphukan defended Assam 17 times against Mughal invasions. During the Battle of Saraighat, despite burning with high fever, Lachit Borphukan led his men to defeat a huge Mughal army with his much smaller force. Unfortunately, due to the excessive physical strain, his health failed him and this great martyr passed on at the age of 49. Till date, Lachit Borphukan remains an enduring symbol of Assamese pride, bravery and resistance. To honor his immortal legacy, the National Defense Academy has instituted a medal known as the Lachit Borphukan medal to recognize the best performing cadet. Recently, our honorable PM Shri Narendra Modi also unveiled a beautiful statue of this inspiring martyr in Jorhat, Assam.

Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru:

Three brave freedom fighters who are now eternal symbols of resistance against British rule in India are Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev Thapar and Shivaram Rajguru. They were all true patriots who shared a deep desire to free India from the clutches of foreign oppression. When they were arrested, news of their trial drew widespread protest across the country as national leaders and thousands of others took to the streets in outrage. But their efforts went unnoticed as Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru were hanged to death on March 23, 1931. Consequently, to honor these heroes of Bharat, March 23 is observed as 'Martyrs' Day' every year.



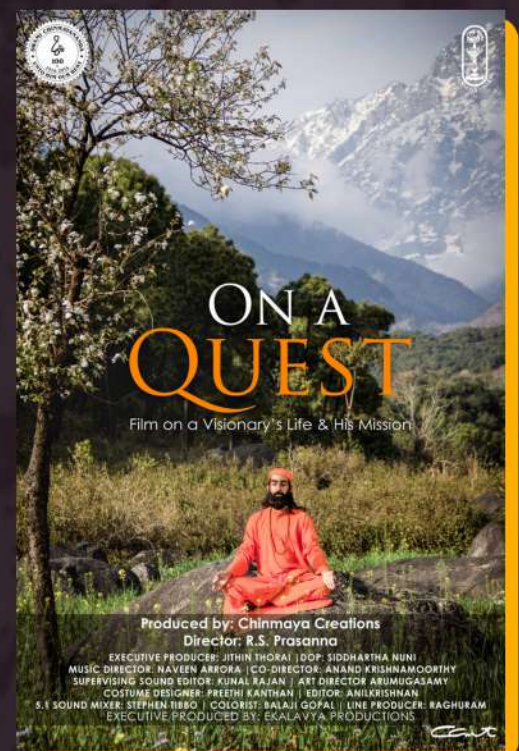
ON A QUEST

THE LIFE AND VISION OF THE MASTER

He was an atheist, journalist and freedom fighter. Young, handsome, and most importantly, rebellious, coated, suited, booted, the journalist headed to Rishikesh! No, it wasn't a pilgrimage. It was a sort of sting-operation! He was determined to unveil the scandal of the Indian monks. But he was in for some surprise! To his utter astonishment, he found them to be a lot of ever-smiling men, dedicated to serving others with selflessness.

He wanted to know the secret of their inner strength. And as he delved deeper, he found the rational answers and inspiring knowledge hidden in the Hindu scriptures. It all left him not just convinced, but transformed. Thus began the story of Swami Chinmayananda - a legacy of an atheist who ended up being the greatest Advaitin the world had seen ever since Swami Vivekananda.

Hard to believe that one man could be so much? Then see for yourself, and be inspired by His life, vision and teachings through this must-watch biopic.





What's

HOW FOOD AFFECTS YOUR MOOD

- MAHEK MEHTA | XII MGMT, CIRS



I am sure your mouth would have started watering just by reading the title. Of course, it's food, after all. One of the most basic and important needs for any living being on this planet is food; from the smallest of creatures to human beings themselves, food acts as an integral part of our lives. Food is more than fuel to the body. It is also involved in an intriguing study called nutritional psychology which indicates the relationship between dietary intake and different aspects of psychological health.

Besides affecting us physically, food has a natural connection to our emotional state. Our mind is filled with a variety of emotions, and food undoubtedly impacts our mood by stimulating different emotions in us. As a Gujarati, I can personally vouch that food items like thepla, locho and gathiya-jalebi can uplift my mood in a matter of seconds! In fact, they make me excited just by looking at them.

This is just one example of the natural impact that food can have on a person's mood. You become either delighted or disappointed when that perfect taste, color and ingredient matches - or does not match - your expectations. Now let's move on to the most common and relatable example of all - chocolate. Even a small bite of it can make us happy in the worst of situations. It is truly remarkable that chocolate has been shown to trigger the release of endorphin and dopamine which are the body's natural feel-good chemicals. These mental chemicals reduce stress and anxiety, leaving you with a lasting sense of calm. Similarly, every CIRS student knows how disappointed and heartbroken we get when we expect paneer on some day - and don't get it. Thus, our expectations and hopes regarding food are also the cause of changes in our mood.

Along with food, there is another factor that has a profound factor on our mood. It is the deep bonds we form while eating. So putting aside your phone and eating with your family and friends creates a positive mood for you. One that spreads joyful vibrations amongst everyone sitting at the table.



GOOD
Food
IS
GOOD
Mood

Cooking?



Going through all of the above information, we can understand how food can create changes in our moods. Here are some practical tips as to what to consume in order to maintain a good mood:

- Start your day with a balanced breakfast.
- Stay hydrated to keep active and energetic.
- Eat mindfully and appreciate the food on your plate.
- Finally, ensure to eat planned, balanced meals containing proper nutrients.

A balanced diet supports cognitive function and mental health. Whereas a poor diet can lead to mood swings and physical ill-health as well. In conclusion, food has a deep influence on us and our moods. Therefore, it is necessary to eat the right kind of food that crafts a truly positive mindset for ourselves.

RESPECT

Lessons from Bharat

DHYOM AMITABH DESAI | GRADE VII, CIRS

Respect is a value that helps people get along. It is important for healthy relationships both personal and professional. Respect helps to build trust, foster cooperation and raise harmonious societies.

अतिथि देवो भव। is a shloka from ancient India that translates to: One's Guest is God. When guests come to our home, we offer them a seat, food, water and treat them with the utmost respect. We greet any elder we meet by touching their feet and seeking their blessings. If we accidentally touch any object with our feet, we instantly ask for forgiveness. In ancient times, whenever there used to be wars, the warring armies would never harm any women or children. Also, attacking the opponent when his back was turned was forbidden, as was slaying an enemy who had surrendered or lost his weapon.

Thus, every aspect of Indian life - from war to peace - was filled with expressions of respect towards everyone and everything. This culture of respect is far more deep and widespread than one would expect - something that we must discover for ourselves.



Solo Love With Me

Unpacking Self-love

AVIRAL AGARWAL | GRADE IX, CIRS



We have all definitely heard the phrase “Love all beings”. But most of us have not heard of “Love yourself”. This advice might sound strange to you. It will probably even raise certain doubts in your mind such as: Is loving myself equivalent to being selfish? Or is loving myself really important, or even necessary? After all, is it not loving others that counts? How does the phrase “Love yourself” relate to me and my life?

Very often we feel that we truly love the people around us. But if this was true and there was really so much love to go around, would the world be like this? Filled as it is with strife, sorrow and suffering? Do these global conflicts not arise out of the lack of love we display towards our fellow living beings?

The truth is that we are unable to love others because we do not truly love ourselves. If we start loving ourselves, all the problems we see outside will resolve themselves.

First, let’s take a look at the love we show to the external world. Let us begin with physical objects, things we use in our daily lives. Our rooms have a lot of objects: A chair, table, fan, bed etc. if we truly loved our things, would we not ensure that we kept everything neat and tidy at all times? Now, let’s take this love a step higher - to the people around us. We find great joy and contentment when our love positively affects those around. We are happy when they are, and we empathise with them when they are sad. These are the lofty heights of pure love that can be seen in our interactions with the outside world.

Next, let’s delve into the love - or rather lack of it - that we show and give ourselves. Consider the question very seriously: Do I really love and take care of myself?

The truth is that we are unable to love others because we do not truly love ourselves. If we start loving ourselves, all the problems we see outside will resolve themselves.

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Now, let us look into the love - or lack of it - that we show and give ourselves. Consider the question very seriously: Do I really love and take care of myself?



Starting at the physical level, you might confidently say yes.

After all, aren't hour-long baths, lengthy sessions before the makeup table, and fussily choosing clothes part of our daily routine? However, these are simply ways of beautifying our external selves. For if we truly loved ourselves would our top priority not be health - both physical and mental? But how many of us consciously follow a wise way of living, a lifestyle conducive to good health? Look around you and you will find people are leading lives that are quite undisciplined, foolishly compromising their health at the altar of wealth or power. To quote a common example, "Makeup can be applied and removed, but a weak and diseased body or mind cannot be healed as easily".



Another phrase that we have heard is "Love alone enhances love". To understand it, take the example of a mobile phone. Imagine that this particular phone has been gifted to you by your parents. It is very dear to your heart and you love it a lot. But will your love for the phone ever surpass your love for your parents? No, right? This is because however much you love your phone it can never love you back. Your parents on the other hand, do reciprocate the love you show them. Hence, the depth of love we show is based on the love we get in return. Now consider that your phone fell and got damaged. Would you grieve excessively over its loss? Although some of us might do so, such a mindset is negative to our growth. From this example we can better understand one more phrase: "Use things and love people".

Upon applying both these quotes in our lives, we can unlock this power and create a more joyful life for ourselves through self-love.

Thus, having read this article, I'm certain that all of you must have understood the true meaning of loving yourself and how it helps you improve physically, mentally and emotionally. Now, it is up to you to imbibe these lessons and implement them in your daily life to see the benefits for yourself. Good luck!

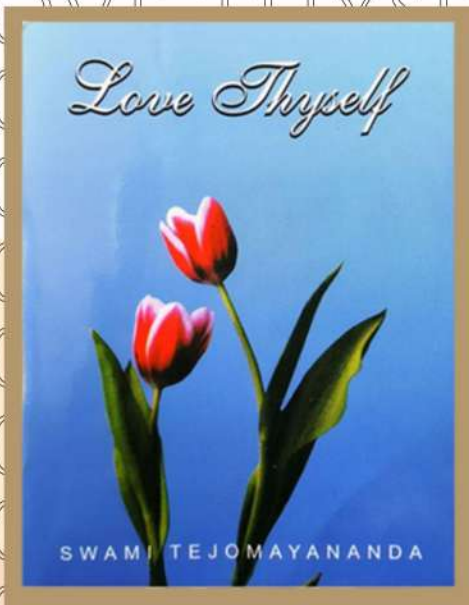


CROSSBUSTERS



LOVE THYSELF

- Swami Tejomayananda



Are you intrigued by what you just read? Do you want to explore the art of loving the objects and people around you further? Then grab the book that inspired the article and let the master himself, Guruji Swami Tejomayananda ji, take you on a profound journey of self love. On every page of this short yet impactful book you will find witty tales, apt examples and powerful teachings that will empower you to transform the way you see, handle and love yourself for life.

"If I love myself truly I must take care to bring about a total integration within myself, which implies a healthy body, an emotionally balanced mind, an alert and subtle intellect."

- Swami Tejomayananda

Captures

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CREATIVE CORNER



T. Muhil - X



Jaival P. - VI



Vedant A. - VII



J. Nidharshan - VIII



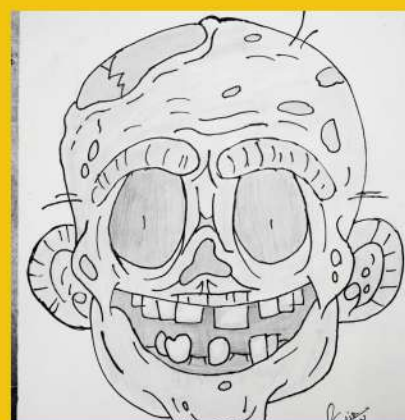
Devritt A. - VIII



Arth A. - VIII



Sahishn R. - VIII



Kartik J. - VIII



Mithra A. ~ VI 🏆



Harshita B. ~ X 🏆



Ritika D. ~ X 🏆



Adhvika ~ X 🏆



Manvi T. ~ IX 🏆



Ram is our culture, our guiding light,
Truth embodied to fight the darkest night.
Ram is dharma, a sagacious saint,
The pulse of this nation, unrestraint.
Ram is the cause, and the effect we see,
In every heart, be it in you or in me.
In every grain, on this sacred ground,
Ram is the echo, a silent sound.
O posterity, let these verses be your guide,
This is Ram for me, Bharat's greatest pride...

Students of Grade X on the occasion of Ram Navāmi:

Aashi, Adhvika, Mihir and Ritika



CLASSIFIEDS



CHYKs are now our only hope. When the younger generation comes to feel inspired by a program of revival, it gathers momentum and floods the heart of that generation with a new spirit of courage and goodwill. - Swami Chinmayananda

April 2025 | Harnessing Youth Potential Through Inspiration

We Celebrate the 'Swachh CIRS Seva' Initiative by our Grade 12 CBSE Students.



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